

The Shade & Undertone Guide

Jimmy's method for natural, undertone-true colour — the same judgement he uses on set, in one page. Read the undertone, choose the depth, develop with care. Colour that looks warm and believable in daylight, never orange, never flat.

01 Read the undertone

Check the inside of the wrist in daylight



Cool

Veins look blue or purple. Silver jewellery flatters. Skin can burn before it tans.

JIMMY'S DIRECTION

Lean to a violet-based formula to keep colour fresh and stop it turning grey or dull.



Neutral

Veins are blue-green; silver and gold both suit. Skin tans steadily and evenly.

JIMMY'S DIRECTION

The most forgiving base — a classic brown formula reads true. Build depth in layers.



Warm

Veins look green; gold jewellery flatters. Skin tans easily and rarely burns.

JIMMY'S DIRECTION

Lean to a green/olive base to balance natural warmth and avoid an orange turn.

02 Choose the depth

Start lighter — you can always build

Natural

A soft, healthy glow. Ideal for fair–light skin and first-timers who want subtlety.

1 coat · buildable

Golden

A warm, sun-kissed finish. Suits light–medium and olive skin, and event-ready colour.

1–2 coats

Deep

Rich, dimensional depth. For medium–deep skin or a confident, red-carpet result.

2 coats · layer evenly

03 Match at a glance

A starting point — adjust to the client

SKIN TONE	UNDERTONE TENDS TO	START WITH	COATS	WATCH FOR
Fair	Cool / neutral	Natural	1	Grey cast — keep it light
Light	Neutral	Natural → Golden	1	Even coverage on dry areas
Medium	Neutral / warm	Golden	1–2	Streaking if under-prepped
Olive	Warm / green	Golden → Deep	1–2	Orange turn — favour olive base
Deep	Warm	Deep	2	Flat, dull result — build depth

04 Develop & rinse

- Let colour develop **6–8 hours** (or per product) before the first rinse.
- Rinse in **lukewarm water only** until it runs clear — no soap yet.
- Colour continues to deepen for **24 hours**; judge the true result the next day.
- For events, tan **1–2 days ahead** so colour settles naturally.

05 Prep & aftercare

- **Exfoliate** 24 hrs before; skip oils and heavy moisturiser on the day.
- Barrier-cream the **hands, knees, elbows & ankles** to stop grabbing.
- Loose, dark clothing after; avoid long showers, sweat & swimming early on.
- **Moisturise daily** to fade evenly — the take-home range extends colour a week+.

JIMMY'S RULE

“Match the base to the undertone, then build in layers. Natural colour is control, not depth — you can always add, you can't easily take away.”